

HOSTFLOW

21 AI Prompts Every Airbnb Host Should Have

Prompts for guest messages, pricing, listing audits, owner outreach, and the 2am panic texts.

Use them in Claude, ChatGPT, or any AI assistant.

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How to use this PDF

Twenty-one prompts. Five categories. Copy-paste into Claude, ChatGPT, or any AI assistant. Each prompt has four parts: when to use it, the prompt itself, why it works, and a variation to make it yours.

The prompts are written for an AI assistant that doesn't have your context yet. Replace the bracketed placeholders with your specifics: [PROPERTY NAME], [ADDRESS], [PASTE INQUIRY], etc. The more context you give the AI, the better the output.

The 5 categories

- Guest Messages
- Pricing & Demand
- Listing Audit
- Owner Outreach
- The 2am Problems

Category 1: Guest Messages

Prompt #1

Inquiry response (first 5 minutes)

When to use: When to use: A new booking inquiry lands and you have less than 5 minutes before the guest moves to the next listing.

The prompt:

You are the cohost for a short-term rental property. A guest just sent this inquiry: [PASTE INQUIRY]. Write a response that does three things in under 100 words: (1) confirms the dates work, (2) asks one qualifying question about the occasion for the trip and headcount, (3) ends with a clear next step. Tone: warm, professional, on-brand for a property that costs \$X per night.

Why it works: Why it works: Guests book the listing that responds first with the most confidence. Asking one qualifying question is what separates high-quality bookings from party bookings.

Variation: Variation: Add the property's house rules PDF to the response and reference a specific rule that applies to their stay length.

Prompt #2

Pre-arrival (24 hours before)

When to use: When to use: 24 hours before a guest's check-in time.

The prompt:

Write a pre-arrival message for a guest staying at [PROPERTY NAME] from [CHECK-IN] to [CHECK-OUT]. Include: smart-lock code or check-in instructions, parking situation, WiFi name and password, the one house rule guests most often miss, and a single question that lets you flag potential issues. Tone: friendly, brief, assume the guest is reading this on their phone in a cab.

Why it works: Why it works: Most issues happen because guests don't read the listing. A great pre-arrival message prevents 80% of them.

Variation: Variation: Include a one-line 'if you need anything, here is my number' — makes the property feel hosted, not abandoned.

Prompt #3

Mid-stay check-in (3+ nights)

When to use: When to use: Mid-stay check-in for any booking 3+ nights. Skip for 1-2 night stays.

The prompt:

Write a mid-stay check-in message for a guest currently at [PROPERTY NAME]. Stay is [CHECK-IN] to [CHECK-OUT]. Day 2 of 3. Don't ask if anything is wrong (no one answers that honestly). Instead, send 3 quick useful items: a local restaurant recommendation that matches what they wrote in their inquiry, the WiFi password again in case they forgot, and a 'we're 30 minutes from the property if you need anything' reassurance. Tone: friendly, brief.

Why it works: Why it works: Mid-stay messages catch the small issues that become bad reviews. They also make the guest feel hosted, which is the actual product.

Variation: Variation: Replace the restaurant rec with a local experience (hike, market, etc.) that matches the season.

Prompt #4

Post-stay thank-you (day of checkout)

When to use: When to use: On the morning of guest checkout.

The prompt:

Write a checkout-day message for a guest leaving [PROPERTY NAME] today. Four sentences max. Include: thank-you, the one thing you hope they enjoyed most, the link to leave a review (mention that reviews help the host they just supported), and a 'next time you're in [CITY], the door is open' close. Tone: warm, not salesy.

Why it works: Why it works: The post-stay message is your one chance to convert a 5-star review before they leave. Most guests forget; a friendly reminder with the review link gets you 30-50% review rates vs the platform average of 20%.

Variation: Variation: If they stayed for a special occasion, mention you'd love to host them again for it next year.

Prompt #5

Bad-review recovery

When to use: When to use: A guest has left a 1-3 star review that contains an issue you can address.

The prompt:

You are the cohost for [PROPERTY NAME]. A guest left this review: [PASTE REVIEW]. The issue is real and not the guest's fault. Write a public review response that does four things: (1) apologizes for the specific issue, not the review, (2) explains what you'll do so it doesn't happen to the next guest, (3) does NOT make excuses, (4) ends with an invitation to stay again and a path to direct contact if they want to discuss. Tone: accountable, brief, professional. Under 150 words.

Why it works: Why it works: Future guests read your review responses more than the reviews themselves. An accountable response builds trust; a defensive one kills bookings.

Variation: Variation: If the issue is structural, mention the specific fix ('we replaced the coffee maker yesterday').

Category 2: Pricing & Demand

Prompt #6

Dynamic pricing review (weekly)

When to use: When to use: Every Friday afternoon, before you set the next week's prices.

The prompt:

I'm a cohost for [PROPERTY NAME]. Pull the trailing 7 days of bookings: [PASTE DATA]. My base price is \$X. Analyze: (1) Are my weekend and weeknight rates properly differentiated? (2) What gap nights do I have in the next 30 days that I should discount? (3) Are there any dates where I'm priced above the comp set median by more than 10%? Recommend specific price adjustments for the next 14 days with reasoning. Don't recommend cuts below 80% of base.

Why it works: Why it works: Most cohosts set a price and forget. Weekly reviews catch the demand shifts that compound into 10-15% annual revenue lift.

Variation: Variation: Add 'compare to the same week last year' for properties with 12+ months of data.

Prompt #7

Comp-set audit (monthly)

When to use: When to use: First Monday of each month.

The prompt:

I'm a cohost for [PROPERTY NAME] in [CITY]. My current nightly rate is \$X. Compare me to these 3 comparable properties within 5 miles: [PASTE LISTINGS OR DESCRIPTIONS]. For each, identify: their nightly rate, weekend uplift, cleaning fee, minimum-night rule, and review velocity (new reviews per 14 days). Then tell me: am I priced correctly, too high, or too low? What's the action item if I'm mispriced? Be specific.

Why it works: Why it works: The comp set is your market. A monthly audit catches shifts (new listings, renovations, owners giving up) before they cost you bookings.

Variation: Variation: If you have more than 3 properties, build a database and run this monthly for all of them.

Prompt #8

Weekend vs weeknight spread

When to use: When to use: When pricing a new property or reviewing an existing one's weekend uplift.

The prompt:

I'm a cohost setting weekend pricing for [PROPERTY NAME]. Current base rate is \$X. Recommend: (1) Friday/Saturday uplift percentage for the next 8 weeks, (2) when to add Thursday night as a weekend-priced night (some markets include Thursday), (3) the minimum stay that maximizes weekend revenue (typically 2-3 nights), (4) any local events in the next 90 days that should drive an additional uplift.

Why it works: Why it works: Weekend and weeknight demand are different markets. Pricing them the same is leaving 15-30% revenue on the table for most properties.

Variation: Variation: For markets with strong mid-week business travel (corporate, medical), recommend a separate mid-week premium instead of a discount.

Prompt #9

Last-minute gap filler

When to use: When to use: A property has 1-3 unfilled nights in the next 14 days.

The prompt:

I have a gap at [PROPERTY NAME] from [DATE] to [DATE]. Currently listed at \$X. Recommend a last-minute strategy: (1) the discount depth (10-30% off is normal), (2) the minimum stay (sometimes 1 night is fine, sometimes a 2-night minimum protects against bad bookings), (3) the messaging in the listing title or pre-approval message that sells the gap ('last-minute mid-week escape'). Tone: confident the discount is a smart move, not desperate.

Why it works: Why it works: Empty nights cost more than the discount. A 20% discount on a night that would otherwise be empty is +20% revenue.

Variation: Variation: For high-ADR properties, recommend NOT discounting below a floor and instead offering a value-add (late checkout, welcome bottle, etc.).

Category 3: Listing Audit

Prompt #10

15-point audit (the full one)

When to use: When to use: Every new listing you take on as a cohost, and quarterly for active listings.

The prompt:

You are auditing the Airbnb listing for [PROPERTY NAME] at [ADDRESS]. Run a 15-point audit covering: title, photo count, hero shot, photo order on each platform, description opening, review score and velocity, calendar sync, minimum-night rules, instant-book setting, pricing strategy, comp set, cleaning turnover, maintenance response time, owner responsiveness, city STR compliance, payout/trust accounting. For each point: 0-4 score, one-line observation, one specific fix. Total expected score: 60.

Why it works: Why it works: This is the same audit Hostflow uses on every new client. It catches 90% of what's actually wrong with a listing without needing a 1-hour deep dive.

Variation: Variation: For new-build properties (just listed), replace point 5 (reviews) with 'launch sequence — pricing ramp, initial reviews strategy.'

Prompt #11

Photo critique

When to use: When to use: Every photo set for a new listing or quarterly refresh.

The prompt:

I'm auditing the photo set for [PROPERTY NAME]. There are X photos in this order: [PASTE ORDER]. Critique each photo on: composition (rule of thirds, leading lines), lighting (golden hour, balanced interior), subject (does it sell the experience), distractions (visible clutter, no people). For the weakest 3 photos, recommend a re-shoot plan (when, what angle, what to remove from frame). End with the photo you would put first if you could reorder.

Why it works: Why it works: Photos are 60-70% of conversion on Airbnb. A 10-minute critique with a re-shoot plan pays for itself in 3 bookings.

Variation: Variation: For budget owners, recommend a smartphone-only re-shoot with a specific time-of-day list and 5 shot types.

Prompt #12

Description rewrite

When to use: When to use: Listing isn't converting despite good photos.

The prompt:

I'm rewriting the listing description for [PROPERTY NAME]. Current description: [PASTE]. Target audience: [CITY] visitors who [USE CASE]. Rewrite the first 3 lines (the only ones visible without clicking). Then rewrite the full description with: (1) the strongest hook in line 1, (2) the property's unique feature in line 2, (3) the experience in line 3, (4) specific amenities and logistics, (5) the closing CTA. Tone: matches the property's vibe. No superlatives without proof.

Why it works: Why it works: Most descriptions are written by owners who don't know what sells. A rewrite focused on what the guest is shopping for can lift conversion 20-40%.

Variation: Variation: For pet-friendly properties, lead with the pet policy in line 1 — pet-friendly travelers filter heavily on this.

Prompt #13

SEO keyword check

When to use: When to use: Before publishing a new listing or quarterly.

The prompt:

I'm checking the SEO on the listing for [PROPERTY NAME] in [CITY]. The listing currently ranks [POSITION] for these searches: [LIST SEARCH TERMS]. Identify: (1) the 5 highest-value keywords this listing should rank for, (2) the 3 keywords the current title and description are missing, (3) the photo-tag opportunities (which photos should have alt text targeting which keywords), (4) the platform-specific SEO differences (Airbnb search vs VRBO search vs Booking.com search). Be specific. Don't suggest changes that would hurt guest readability.

Why it works: Why it works: Most listings are invisible to search because owners write for humans, not for the algorithm. A keyword check + light optimization can lift impressions 30%+.

Variation: Variation: For Airbnb-specific properties, ignore SEO and focus on the listing quality score instead (response rate, acceptance rate, completion rate).

Category 4: Owner Outreach

Prompt #14

Cold pitch (listing-mining)

When to use: When to use: You spot a stale listing in your market and want to reach the owner.

The prompt:

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I'm a cohost in [CITY]. I just reviewed the listing at [ADDRESS] and noticed two patterns: [SPECIFIC OBSERVATION 1] and [SPECIFIC OBSERVATION 2]. Both usually cost owners in this market $X/year. I'm offering a free 15-minute audit of the listing – no pitch, no contract, just observations on what's fixable. If you're interested, reply with a time that works and I'll send a calendar link.
```

Why it works: Why it works: Owners are drowning in 'let me manage your Airbnb' spam. A specific observation + a free audit (no pitch) stands out and gets replies.

Variation: Variation: For owners with multiple listings, mention you'd audit all of them.

Prompt #15

Follow-up after no reply (7 days)

When to use: When to use: 7 days after sending a cold pitch that got no response.

The prompt:

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Following up on the audit offer I sent last week. If you weren't interested or the timing is off, no problem – happy to take you off the list. If you are still curious but didn't get to it, I can do the audit async (just the link to your listing) and send you the observations in writing – no calendar needed. Reply 'send it' if that works.
```

Why it works: Why it works: Most cold pitches die in inbox. One well-timed follow-up doubles the reply rate. The 'async' alternative is the unlock — busy owners will reply to that when they won't reply to a calendar invite.

Variation: Variation: For owners you suspect are skeptical, replace 'send it' with 'skip it' — gives them a clean exit that paradoxically re-engages.

Prompt #16

Discovery call opener (first 5 minutes)

When to use: When to use: The first 5 minutes of a discovery call with a prospect.

The prompt:

I'm about to take a discovery call with a property owner who has [ADDRESS] listed on Airbnb. They responded to my cold pitch. Open the call with: (1) a thank-you for the time, (2) one specific thing I noticed about their listing (proves I actually looked at it), (3) the two questions I want to answer in the next 25 minutes: 'what's working for you right now?' and 'what's not?'. Don't pitch anything in the first 5 minutes. Tone: curious, not selling.

Why it works: Why it works: The first 5 minutes set the tone for the whole call. Asking what's working first prevents you from skipping the part where the owner tells you what's actually wrong.

Variation: Variation: For owners who are time-pressed, replace the second opener with 'I noticed [X] — was that your decision or just how it ended up?'

Prompt #17

Audit delivery message

When to use: When to use: Sending the audit to the owner after the call.

The prompt:

Write the email that goes out 48 hours after the discovery call with [PROPERTY NAME] owner. The audit is attached. Cover: (1) what I looked at, (2) the top 3 fixes I'd make in week 1 if I were their cohost, (3) the top 3 fixes for month 1, (4) my proposed engagement model + fee, (5) when I'd like to follow up to discuss. Tone: direct, specific, not selling. The audit does the selling.

Why it works: Why it works: The audit delivery email is the moment the owner decides. A vague email loses to a specific one. Specificity is the entire sales motion.

Variation: Variation: For owners who seem skeptical on the call, add 'if any of this doesn't resonate, I'd genuinely like to know why — it helps me do better on the next audit.'

Prompt #18

Monthly statement draft

When to use: When to use: Drafting the monthly owner statement at the start of each month.

The prompt:

I'm drafting the monthly statement for [PROPERTY NAME] owner for [MONTH YEAR]. Data: revenue \$X, expenses \$Y, net payout \$Z. Last month: revenue \$A, expenses \$B, net payout \$C. Draft the statement with: (1) a 1-line summary at the top, (2) a revenue breakdown, (3) an expense line-item list with vendor names, (4) the cohost fee, (5) the net payout (bold), (6) a 2-line 'coming up next month' note, (7) any open actions the owner needs to take. Tone: clear, brief, professional. Owner should be able to read it in 90 seconds.

Why it works: Why it works: The monthly statement is the single biggest retention tool. Owners who understand their numbers stay; owners who don't, leave. A clear statement is a relationship tool.

Variation: Variation: For owners who want more detail, add a 'this month vs market' comparison.

Category 5: The 2am Problems

Prompt #19

Guest lockout (after hours)

When to use: When to use: A guest is locked out and it's 2am.

The prompt:

Guest is locked out at [PROPERTY NAME]. Property has [LOCK TYPE]. I am the cohost. Write the response that: (1) acknowledges the issue in under 10 words, (2) gives the immediate workaround (where's the spare key, who can come in under 30 min, what's the alternative access code), (3) apologizes for the issue (specific to the lock, not generic), (4) commits to fixing it so it doesn't happen again, (5) offers a small gesture of goodwill (free late checkout, partial refund). Tone: urgent, calm, accountable.

Why it works: Why it works: Lockouts are the #1 cause of bad reviews for a property with smart locks. A great response converts a 2am crisis into a 5-star review.

Variation: Variation: For properties with traditional locks (no smart access), specify the lockbox code protocol separately from the lockout response.

Prompt #20

Neighbor complaint (escalation)

When to use: When to use: A neighbor has called/texted/emailed about noise, parking, or guests at the property.

The prompt:

Neighbor [NAME] just contacted me about [ISSUE: noise / parking / guest behavior] at [PROPERTY NAME] at [TIME]. Current guest is [NAME], staying [CHECK-IN to CHECK-OUT]. Write the response to: (1) the neighbor (acknowledge, apologize specifically, commit to action), (2) the guest (warn that noise/parking/etc. needs to stop now without being aggressive), (3) the property owner (inform, propose long-term fix). All three messages in this response. Tone: accountable, brief, no excuses.

Why it works: Why it works: Neighbor complaints are STR-killer events. Cities revoke licenses based on repeat complaints. A great response can save the property.

Variation: Variation: For repeat-offender properties, recommend a noise monitor in the listing audit. Don't deploy it without explicit owner approval.

Prompt #21

Damage claim (first response)

When to use: When to use: The cleaning crew has reported damage and you need to start the claim with the guest.

The prompt:

Damage reported at [PROPERTY NAME] after [GUEST NAME] checkout. Damage: [DESCRIPTION]. Estimated cost: \$X. Photos attached. Guest stayed [DATE RANGE]. Write the response to: (1) the guest (inform of the damage, reference the booking agreement's damage clause, request a response within 24 hours, do NOT demand payment), (2) the owner (inform, recommend next steps: file Airbnb resolution claim if cost >\$250), (3) the cleaning crew (thank, no further action needed). Tone: factual, brief, no emotional language. Future-proofed for a resolution claim if it goes that far.

Why it works: Why it works: Damage claims are the highest-stakes message you'll send. A great response sets up the resolution case; a bad response waives your claim before you've filed it.

Variation: Variation: For minor damage (<\$100), consider absorbing the cost and not messaging the guest. Calculate the cost of the message vs the cost of the damage.

If these prompts helped.

The prompts above are the front door. The HostFlow STR Starter System has the full operating playbook behind them — 10 modules, 50+ SOPs, the 18-clause cohost contract, the dynamic pricing rules, and a 30-day plan to land your first client.

\$49. PDF + contract template + 30-day planning calendar. Instant download. Yours forever.

What's in the \$49 Starter System:

- Module 1 — Cohosting 101: what it is, what it isn't, the 3 fee models
- Module 2 — The 30-day plan to land your first cohosting client
- Module 3 — Pricing your service: the math + 4 worked examples
- Module 4 — The cohost contract: 18-clause template + 3 fee model variants
- Module 5 — The listing audit: 15-point audit for every new client
- Module 6 — Guest screening: 4-question pre-approval + 10 industry variants
- Module 7 — Dynamic pricing: manual rules + when to use software
- Module 8 — The monthly statement: what owners see + how to send one
- Module 9 — Owner outreach: 5 email scripts + 4 channels for finding clients
- Module 10 — Scaling 1-5 properties: the time-per-property milestones + when to hire

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Cohosting is work. No income guarantees. Results depend on your market and effort.